burden on Earth with overproduction. So, we've started talking about sustainability being an essential part of what we do with the Magnum Eco range. We've made bags with yoghurt cups and used bottles. We put solar panels in our factories much before many did. We have a tree plantation in Nasik every year. All these efforts align with Samsonite Global's ethos towards a greener planet.

As you mentioned earlier about taking risks, as the CEO, how much of it is intuitive?

I'd be lying if I said that data and proof back all my decisions. That's my job to take risks and take responsibility for that. A CEO's job is difficult, as making decisions comes with repercussions. That said, 90 per cent of my choices are based on knowledge of what's happening in the Indian market. I travel 12 days a month, including to the smaller towns, and I discuss my learnings with the solid team to get clarification on my decisions.

As the industry leader with both your brands, how do you view competition?

We may be the best at what we do, but that doesn't mean we don't look around. If any company can do something better than us in any aspect, we learn from it. But we will also beat them at it. The entry barriers in our industry are not too high because it's not a high-tech business. So, there will always be many companies entering and exiting, but we don't take any brand lightly, even if it's just a three-year-old story.

Does that also include unbranded bags?

Unbranded bags are huge in India. There is a segment that thinks anything goes, and a bag is a bag is a bag. However, fortunately, more and more people are now turning to brands. As a leading company, we have been able to provide the best products at prices that are within reach. Our brand Kamiliant is at the lower end. So, people usually move to brands with an affordable name and then hop on to the bigger one, in our case, American Tourister and Samsonite. That helps us.

Finally, what's the greatest challenge for you as a brand?

The biggest challenge is the clarity of thought regarding brand architecture. Each brand has to stand for something and have a way of speaking to consumers. And Samsonite India has managed to demarcate the three brands – Samsonite, American Tourister and Kamiliant in that sense.